published, two members of the US House of Representatives from Michigan—John Conyers, a liberal Democrat, and Justin Amash, a conservative Republican—introduced the House Amendment Act, a bill to defund the NSA's domestic spying programs. At a time when the two parties agreed and cooperated on very little, their proposal gained surprising support and lost by only a small margin, 205 to 217 votes.[4] Lawmakers said their votes in favor of the bill reflected a concern among voters about personal privacy. "There is a growing sense that things have really gone a-kilter here," US representative Zoe Lofgren told a reporter about NSA surveillance.[5]

On May 22, 2014, a revised and weakened version of the USA Freedom Act was passed in the House by a vote of 302 to 121.[6] The Senate failed to pass the bill in

PAST INTELLIGENCE MISDEEDS

US intelligence organizations have had a history of acting unethically and even illegally. For example, upon discovering in 1963 that Martin Luther King Jr. was having an extramarital affair, the FBI tried to use that information to talk King into killing himself. The CIA tested mind-altering drugs such as LSD on unwitting citizens, plotted to assassinate world leaders such as Cuba's Fidel Castro, and spied on anti-Vietnam War protestors. In the 1970s, US senator Frank Church exposed NSA, CIA, and FBI misdeeds to the public, resulting in reforms such as FISA.

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